
“It’s estimated today that the global economy is getting affected by cybercrime to the tune of around \$6 trillion a year. That’s roughly about 7-8 per cent of the global GDP and that’s only going to increase”

are also craving more in-person time with their teams. At least half are at an intersection as they want both. What that basically means is that technology is going to take on a central role in the future of work.

110 | Now, the future of work is hybrid, especially in large groups. We’ve [also] learnt that the work signals continue pre-meeting and post-meeting. Therefore, a lot of technology is being thought through as to how do we continuously engage and get work done? That’s one big trend line that is causing hybrid work to be a definite future of work. The hybrid [model] will be different for different companies and within a company for different teams. The metaverse will facilitate these interactions.

Now I will build on pure data, public cloud usage—that is a very big part of technology. Digital natives or unicorns always had a lot of born-in-the-cloud kind of capabilities. They were always working to use technology to build their core systems. One sector that has changed most dramatically in the last two years is the Indian banking sector—[that has a] very high comfort of using the public cloud—[and] are now leveraging data, AI and ML. The other place I [have] seen this trendline work very differently, in terms of the leverage of tech data, is in many of the government capabilities. The public platforms that are being created in the government, such as Aadhaar and UPI, are now stepping into the health platforms, labour platforms, agri platforms, skilling platforms—[they] will have huge leverage of technology, where you can use services sort of 24x7. The third vertical is healthcare, [which is a] great place to think about how the leverage of tech is changing. [It was] partly caused by the pandemic, where medical practitioners—both doctors and nurses—and hospitals became comfortable connecting with their patients [online].

Q: How has the threat landscape evolved and what is Microsoft doing in this space?

A: [The] threat landscape is the biggest conversation that I have with almost every stakeholder who is



thinking about technology. It’s estimated today that the global economy is getting affected by cybercrime to the tune of around \$6 trillion a year. That’s roughly about 7-8 per cent of the global GDP and that’s only going to increase. So it is a very realistic, big economic imperative to work on cybercrime and all kinds of cyber threats.

Second, the geopolitical landscape globally has caused nation-states to get involved in driving some of the cybercrime and they could be targeting enterprises that are private or commercial. Therefore, cybercrime is not just increasing but the threat of it is going up because it can affect critical industries in the country of the target.

If you see our business, just security—including cybersecurity and many other elements of trust—is the largest such business on the planet. In terms of comparison, if you take a pure-play cybersecurity company, we would [be] multiple times the size of it. Just last year, we were looking at 8 trillion signals a day, and that creates machine learning and a lot of capability. Just in